

Holidays

Centro Linguistico di Ateneo
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Grammar Focus	Topic Focus
Verbs	**Discussing Holidays**
Past Simple	Types of holidays
Past Continuous	
	Sites and resorts
I used to (do)	
I am used to (doing)	Means of transport
Would	
	Holiday equipment
Present Participle	
Past Participle	

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hen-destinations
holidays-hen
golf-holidays
spa-holidays
holidays-honeymoon
waterpark-holidays
market-breaks
holidays-family
christmas-holidays
honeymoon-destinations
couples-holidays
multi-centre
holidays-babymoon
holidays-inclusive
year-eve
holidays-multi
inclusive-holidays
seaside-holidays
new-year
castle-holidays
destinations-waterpark
eve-holidays
breaks-new
holidays-gay
luxury-holidays
destinations-stag
centre-holidays
holidays-luxury
clubbing-holidays
christmas-market
holidays-christmas
destinations-seaside
holidays-spa
family-holidays
-undefined
gay-holidays
holidays-castle
holidays-golf
babymoon-
package-holidays
stag-destinations
holidays-couples
holidays-clubbing

Holidays

The word **holiday** is used for important days that are celebrated by a lot of people. Holidays are celebrated usually by your whole country or whole culture. Examples of holidays include **Christmas** for Christians, **Ramadan** for Muslims, and **Passover** for Jewish people.

Some holiday celebrations often involve traditions like **decorations, parades, or special foods**.

Holidays can have **religious significance**, or they can be **important historical dates**: a lot of **businesses and schools close** and many people have **days off from work and from school**. For example, in the US they celebrate Independence Day on July 4th, while in the UK there are **Bank Holidays**, such as the May Day Bank Holiday on May 1st.

Originally, the term '**Bank Holiday**' designated the **holidays enjoyed by bank workers**, which were 33 days a year until 1834. They were then reduced to just four, but extended to other sectors, with the exception of workers employed in essential services, in order for these workers to be able to enjoy cricket matches!

Vacation

The word **vacation**, in the US, refers to your **personal time off from work or school** – usually an extended time, not just one day – and **vacations often involve travelling**.

Some people go on vacation to the **beach**, others go to the **mountains**, others go to **another city**, or to the **countryside**, or to an **amusement park**.

But here's where it **gets tricky** (complicated) – when you're in the middle of a vacation, which is your personal time off from work or school, and which usually involves travelling, **American English** speakers say **you are on vacation**, but **British English** speakers say **you are on holiday**.

That is because in **American English**, a **holiday** is a **special day** like **Christmas** or **Independence Day**, and a vacation is **time off from work when you usually travel**. But in **British English**, the word **holiday** is used for **both these things**.

Holidays

There are many kinds of holidays, and all of them usually have the same purpose: to relax, to have fun and, perhaps, to visit the attractions of a new city or country.

Some people prefer to go to an all-inclusive resort, where they can just relax, sunbathe and perhaps do some sports, without having to worry about anything except having fun. Others choose to spend their holiday visiting cities, museums and historical landmarks, either in their own country, or abroad. Camping, cruises, tours, hikes, LGBT-friendly and luxury destinations, all offer different and exciting ways to spend a fantastic holiday!

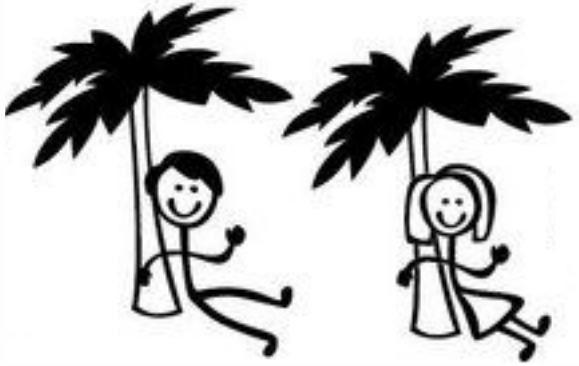
There is also another kind of holiday, that which marks a very special event. The one everyone knows is the Honeymoon, the holiday that **newlyweds** (NOVELLI SPOSI) usually have after the wedding ceremony.

Other special occasions are **Hen and Stag Parties** and **Babymoons**.
A **Hen Party** is a getaway of a few days for the girlfriends of the future **bride** (SPOSA). A **Stag Party** is the same, but for the male friends of the future **groom** (SPOSO). It's the bride and groom's last chance to go wild before the wedding! Drinking, dancing and lots of silly activities are traditionally part of these short holidays. A **Babymoon** is the last vacation the future parents take together before the birth of their baby.

Types of Holidays

All-Inclusive Holidays:

All-inclusive holidays burst onto the tourism scene around the turn of the Millennium, as tour operators and resorts did their best to cater for visitors who didn't feel the need to explore far from their accommodation.
Most all-inclusive holiday deals include the main elements of a package holiday, such as flights and rooms, but also extras like entertainment, food, and sometimes drinks too.
All-inclusive package holidays are ideal if you plan to relax and spend your entire holiday in the resort without needing any extra spending money - although in practice it is sensible to take some currency with you for any extra purchases, souvenirs, and trips out of the resort.





Types of Holidays

Luxury Holidays:

The most stylish accommodation, the most comfortable flights, and the most desirable destinations on the planet: the very best of the world at your fingertips, travelling in style!

Among the top destinations for luxury holidays in South America is Brazil, and the islands of Aruba, Barbados and Bahamas, too. Other destinations for your luxury beach holidays include other archipelagos in or adjacent to the Caribbean Sea, the dream long-haul destinations of the Southern Hemisphere, and a vast selection of luxury holidays in different Mediterranean locations, from the coastline of the sea itself, to the islands dotted within it.



Wherever you want to spend your next holiday, whether for just a few days, or several weeks, the world is your oyster!

Types of Holidays



Family-Friendly Holidays:

A family holiday is a bonding experience, a way to make memories that will last a lifetime, and it broadens the horizons of your children's world too.

Family holidays are not just about the kids, though. A good family holiday gives you time together, but also a chance to relax - after all, it's your holiday too. Whether that means relaxing together by the pool or on the beach, a scheduled excursion or guided tour to keep the kids occupied, or specific entertainment to take them out of your hair completely for a few hours, a family holiday is designed to make sure everybody comes home from their holiday with a smile on their faces.

Types of Holidays



Hen (GALLINA) Party (ADDIO AL NUBILATO):

What better way to celebrate getting married than planning the perfect hen party with your closest girlfriends?

For the ultimate girls' getaway, the bride-to-be can choose between a stunning range of destinations for hen weekends abroad, whether she's looking to party in a city, or to go for an exciting weekend on a gorgeous beach break with the girls!

For example Marbella, known as Spain's answer to St. Tropez, with its white-washed buildings and crystal-clear waters, is the perfect setting for a relaxing swim before getting ready for the evening's wildest dances and parties!

Types of Holidays

Stag (CERVO MASCHIO) Party (ADDIO AL CELIBATO):

The perfect Stag Party can begin on the infamous (scandalous) Catamaran party cruises, which include an on-board DJ and free drinks: enough to make any group of young men very happy!

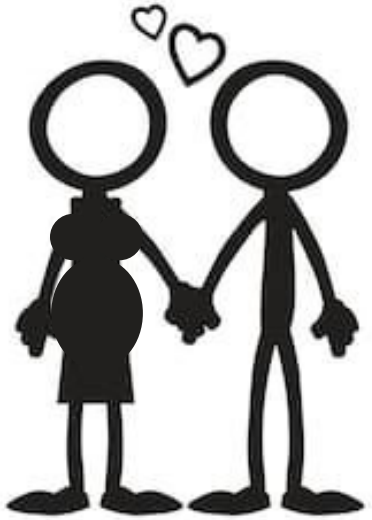
The groom-to-be and his mates can also go to Ibiza, for the bar crawl (a tour of all the best bars in the city in one night) of a lifetime, before hitting (going to) some of the world's hottest nightclubs.

From crazy booze (alcohol) cruises, to world-famous nightclubs, Amsterdam is also one of the best cities to have a Stag Party!

And with countless tasting houses (known as 'Proeflokalen') serving everything from home-brewed craft ale to Heineken, there's only one phrase you'll need to remember during your time away: 'Nog een biertje, alsjeblieft' ('Another beer, please!').



Types of Holidays



Babymoons:

Tourist facilities are getting more and better equipped to welcome expectant couples. Obviously, one mustn't choose adventurous or difficult trips, but select places that can offer moments of relaxation, where the future mother can chill out in a spa or participate in yoga sessions.
The couple's choice often falls on places full of quiet, where it is possible to take long and calming walks, where nature is lush and offers beautiful landscapes.
A romantic weekend in a resort near an ancient village or in an enchanting castle, or at a farmhouse immersed in the countryside, to enjoy the local products and feed the baby farm animals.
A hotel by the sea, to benefit from the saline air, or venture into a lodge near a wooded area, to experience forest therapy.
A classic romantic getaway, in an artistic city or in a secluded corner of paradise near the sea or on a lake, can also be a great idea for the last holiday as a couple, before the baby's birth.

Types of Holidays

Ski Holidays:

A ski holiday involves going to a ski resort and enjoying speeding down the white slopes, or getting a great tan while sipping a hot chocolate or a warm glass of mulled wine (VINO SPEZIATO), surrounded by an amazing view of the snow-capped mountains.



You can choose to book a ski package which may include your lift pass, as well as ski/board and boot hire. And after a day on the slopes, you can relax in your chalet, flat, or hotel room.

When staying in a chalet or hotel, you can also be in HB - Half Board - (MEZZA PENSIONE) or FB - Full Board - (PENSIONE COMPLETA) and enjoy breakfast, lunch or afternoon tea, as well as an evening 3 or 4 course meal, while sipping a superb red wine.

Means of Transport

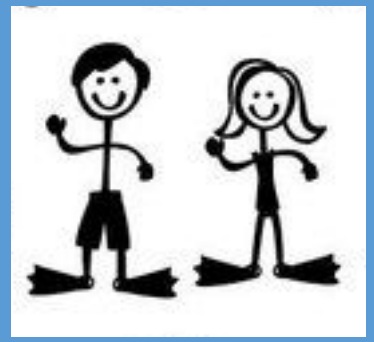
You can reach your holiday destination:
By airplane (or plane)
By train
By car
By bus
By van
By helicopter
By rowboat
By ship
By ferry
By motorcycle
By bike
By tube (UK) / subway (US)
By hot air balloon
By taxi (UK) / cab US)
By tram (UK) / streetcar (US)
On foot
Or hitchhiking!



…can you think of any other means of transport?

Holiday Equipment

For a holiday at the sea:
Swimwear, such as trunks, swimsuits, shorts, bikinis, briefs, tankinis.
Accessories, from swimming caps, goggles and ear plugs to towels, bags and swimming aids.



For a holiday in the mountains:
Skiwear, ski equipment and accessories: jacket, trousers, skis, snowboard, boots and poles, a mask or goggles and, of course, a helmet.

